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SELECT DROPDOWN HANDLING

(Playwright + TypeScript)

In Playwright, handling **select dropdowns** is super easy! We use the **selectOption()** method.

! IMPORTANT!

`selectOption()` only works with HTML `<select>` tags! For custom dropdowns (div-based), we need different approach!

3 Ways to Select Options 🎨

- 1 **By Value** - using the value attribute
- 2 **By Label** - using visible text (most readable!)
- 3 **By Index** - using position (0, 1, 2...)

Method 1: Select by Value 🟡

Uses the **value** attribute from the HTML option tag



TypeScript Code

```
// Locate the dropdown element
let day: Locator = page.locator('#day');
let month: Locator = page.locator('#month');
let year: Locator = page.locator('#year');

// Select by value attribute
```

```
await day.selectOption('5'); // value="5"  
await month.selectOption('10'); // value="10"  
await year.selectOption('2020'); // value="2020"
```

HTML looks like:

```
<option value="5">5</option>  
<option value="10">10</option>
```

Method 2: Select by Label (Visible Text) ●

Uses the visible text that user sees! **Most Readable!** ✨

 TypeScript Code

```
// Select by visible text (label)  
await day.selectOption({ label: '15' });  
await month.selectOption({ label: 'Jun' });  
await year.selectOption({ label: '2010' });
```

💡 **PRO TIP!**

This is the best method for readability! Anyone can understand what "Jun" or "15" means!

Method 3: Select by Index ●

Uses the position number (starts from 0)

 TypeScript Code

```
// Select by index (position)  
await day.selectOption({ index: 2 }); // 3rd option  
await month.selectOption({ index: 11 }); // 12th option  
await year.selectOption({ index: 6 }); // 7th option
```

⚡ **Remember:**

Index starts from 0! So index: 2 means the 3rd option in the list



REMEMBER!

All three methods do the same thing! Choose the one that makes your test most readable and maintainable!

Making Reusable Functions

Instead of repeating code, create helper functions! This makes your code **DRY**
(Don't Repeat Yourself)

Function 1: Select by Value



Reusable Function

```
async function selectDropDownByValue(  
  element: Locator,  
  value: string  
) : Promise<void> {  
  await element.selectOption(value);  
  await expect(element).toHaveValue(value);  
}
```

// Usage:

```
await selectDropDownByValue(day, '5');  
await selectDropDownByValue(month, '10');
```

Function 2: Select by Label



Reusable Function

```
async function selectDropDownByLabel(  
  element: Locator,  
  labelValue: string  
) : Promise<void> {  
  await element.selectOption({ label: labelValue });  
  let selectedValue = await element.inputValue();  
  await expect(element).toHaveValue(selectedValue);  
}
```

```
// Usage:  
await selectDropDownByLabel(day, '15');  
await selectDropDownByLabel(month, 'Jun');
```

Function 3: Select by Index



Reusable Function

```
async function selectDropDownByIndex(  
  element: Locator,  
  indexVal: number  
) : Promise<void> {  
  await element.selectOption({ index: indexVal });  
  let selectedValue = await element.inputValue();  
  await expect(element).toHaveValue(selectedValue);  
}  
  
// Usage:  
await selectDropDownByIndex(day, 10);  
await selectDropDownByIndex(month, 4);
```

Real World Example



Facebook Date of Birth Selection:

```
// Navigate to Facebook signup  
await page.goto('https://www.facebook.com/r.php');  
  
// Locate dropdowns  
let day = page.locator('#day');  
let month = page.locator('#month');  
let year = page.locator('#year');  
  
// Select birth date: June 15, 2000  
await day.selectOption({ label: '15' });  
await month.selectOption({ label: 'Jun' });  
await year.selectOption({ label: '2000' });
```

X COMMON MISTAKES

× Using `selectOption()` on non-select elements (like div dropdowns)

- × Forgetting index starts from 0
- × Not waiting for dropdown to be ready before selecting
- × Mixing up value vs label (they're different!)

Quick Comparison

Method	When to Use?	Readability
By Value	When value is meaningful	☆☆
By Label	Best for readability!	☆☆☆☆☆
By Index	When position matters	☆

✨ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Use `selectOption()` for HTML select dropdowns
- Three ways: by value, by label (best!), by index
- Create reusable functions to avoid code duplication
- Always add assertions to verify selection worked!
- By Label method is most readable for teams ✨

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